

can book appointments, collect the consultation fees, sanitise the customer's hands and disinfect the body while printing the appointment receipt. The Nightingale Robot has an integrated AI solution that automatically tracks early symptoms of COVID-19, and can perform elementary tests on the patient such as body temperature, heartbeat, respiratory rate and blood oxygen levels, and direct them to the appropriate areas of the hospital for further consultation. There are two additional COVID-19 special robots meant to be deployed in hospitals, to combat the contagion. The autopure is a robotic sanitiser that uses UV disinfection to keep areas safe and clean. The other is the COVID-19 Steward can be used to deliver medicines, food and other necessary supplies to COVID-19 patients, reducing the exposure of the healthcare workers to the virus. Rama Raju Singam, Founder of Vistan NextGen said, "we are very excited to be part of the new phase of automation in India with the introduction of Flunkey robots. With Make in India philosophy, we have decided to conceptualise, design and manufacture robots within India and in the process of building the entire ecosystem, we are training our vendors to design specialised circuit boards and also upskilling our workforce through learning platforms. Our robots are equipped to perform more complex and sensitive jobs seamlessly and can also outperform humans in terms of time, accuracy and efforts"

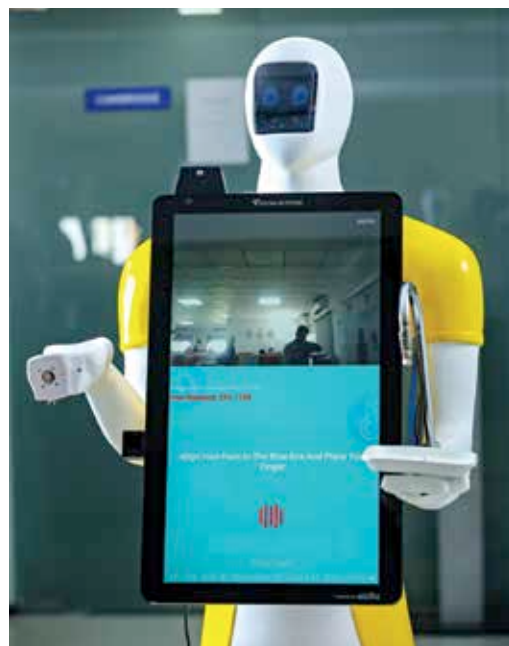
Hero Electrolux updated its existing Qubo line of smart cameras with an AI-based COVID guard feature, developed by the in house research team, working remotely through the outbreak. The technology allows the smart, connected indoor surveillance cameras to ensure that employees at a workplace, or shoppers at a kirana store, are maintaining COVID appropriate behavior such as social distancing and wearing masks. In what is both life saving and irritating, the cameras can be configured to give an audio warning through their inbuilt speakers when the norms are being flouted. Additionally, the manager or

store owner can get images or video clips when the AI recognises that the rules are not being followed. Nikhil Rajpal, CEO, Hero Electronix says, "with the changing scenario for businesses, ensuring business continuity while also implementing health and safety compliances will be a challenge most businesses aren't prepared for. Despite the challenges due to lockdown, COVID Guard features were developed in house by the team working remotely to help businesses to gradually head back to normalcy. Social distancing and wearing masks is the new normal, with COVID-Guard we are leveraging our expertise in developing AI-based solutions to solve a major real-world problem which has become a public health crisis. We believe that with this feature, employers can remain at ease and focus on their businesses while Qubo cameras work round the clock to ensure safety across the work premises."

DaalChini, a food tech platform owned by ex PayTM employees, is using kiosks to provide contactless automated food at housing complexes, malls, MNCs, coworking spaces and educational institutions around the country, and at the Fortis, Max, Kailash, and Sanjeev Hospitals in Delhi. At these hospitals, the vending machines are being refilled three to four times a day.

About keeping things running through the restrictions, Prerna Kalra, Co-Founder DaalChini says, "being an essential service and by nature being 24*7 accessible, we have seen higher consumptions than normal in locations where we were operational in these tough times. This was partly due to the unmanned option (hence social distancing) and partly due to unavailability of resources for other F&B options at the location." In the residential areas, DaalChini had some thoughtful additions to the vending machines that normally only provided food "during these

tough times, we tried to be useful as much as possible by taking some key strategic decisions. In residential locations, we added Ready-to-cook, Groceries and Milk as well. We even added Sanitisers, Masks, Wet-tissues to help the customers in these locations." As a response to the pandemic, DaalChini also made the process completely contactless payments. Kalra explains, "Pre-covid we had an option where the customer could buy from the App and can collect the item from the Kiosk. Post-Covid, we made the 100% Contactless option where customer can buy with the app, scan the QRcode to vend the item then use a foot-paddle stand to open the pickup pocket and collect."



The Shushruth robot by Vistan NextGen

To address the ongoing crisis, Yellow Messenger, a conversational AI chatbot platform has launched a CSR initiative that allows any company addressing the pandemic to get a free omnichannel chatbot, no questions asked. Raghu Ravinutala, CEO and Co-Founder of Yellow Messenger said "You could be an NGO, a hospital, an insurance company, or simply a voluntary organization. All you need to do is let us know how you are contributing and the kind of chatbot services you need and we'll help you launch a chatbot to reach out and support the masses".